

# The DP-Internal Origin of Datives\*

Richard S. Kayne  
New York University

## 1. Introduction.

There are two long-standing traditions concerning the dative/indirect object in English double object sentences such as:

(1) Mary gave Susan a copy of her paper.

In the 1960s, the dative was taken to originate as the object of *to* (or *for*), with that preposition subsequently being deleted, and the dative moved, by transformation, in the course of the derivation. On the other hand, Oehrle (1976) later argued for a non-transformational account.

The applicative approach to double object sentences associated with Pylkkänen (2008) and others since is akin to Oehrle's in not having the arguments move (apart from *wh*-movement, etc.), though it differs from Oehrle's in having there be a silent applicative head (which has something in common with the deleted *P* of the earlier transformational account).

The applicative approach in addition takes different subtypes of datives to have different heights, in a way that has something in common with Rizzi's (1997) having Topic*P* higher than Focus*P*, and with Cinque's (1999) functional hierarchy. In Rizzi's case, especially for Focus*P*, it's virtually certain that the argument in Spec,Foc*P* gets there by movement, rather than being externally merged there.

The same question of internal merge (movement) vs. external merge ('base-generation') arises for each of Rizzi's other Specs, for each of Cinque's Adv*Ps*, and for each Spec,App*P*. For the last of these, the Oehrle - Pylkkänen tradition takes the dative in an English double object sentence not to have been moved into its canonical position.

The question of internal vs. external merge can be asked about datives more generally, including in cases where there is a visible *P*, as in most Romance, when the dative is lexical.

In this paper, I will suggest (though I won't attempt to look at the entire range of datives) that datives are moved (internally merged) into what we think of as their canonical DOC position. If this is correct, then the movement tradition of the 1960s will have turned out to be more on the right track (in that respect) than the applicative tradition.<sup>1</sup>

Put more generally, the following conjecture seems plausible:<sup>2</sup>

(2) All arguments invariably raise at least once,<sup>3</sup> in all languages.

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<sup>1</sup>Though note Nie (2020) for the idea that certain Spec,App*P* positions are moved into.

<sup>2</sup>The idea that argument phrases must raise at least once recalls Moro's (1997, 139) proposal that "predicates apply only to variables at LF", a proposal that took the trace/copy theory of movement to be correct, whereas the text 'raise at least once' proposal is neutral as to the correctness of that theory. A second difference has to do with Kayne's (1981b) interpreting the locality difference between French object clitic movement and French *tout*-movement to reflect the fact that *tout*-movement is linked to a variable while clitic movement is not. Perhaps obligatory raising reflects the language

If (2) is correct, then we have, for the subcase of dative arguments, the following:  
(3) No dative argument is externally merged into its visible position.

The formulation given in (3) leaves open the question of where exactly datives originate. In what follows, I will explore the possibility that Szabolcsi's (1983; 1994) position, taken together with the 'possessor raising' tradition, can be generalized to:<sup>4</sup>

(4) All dative arguments originate DP-internally.

2. Some datives are clearly DP-internal.

One case is that of dative possessors in Hungarian. Szabolcsi argues that when the DP is definite the pre-D dative possessor, which originates as a post-D nominative possessor within DP, can remain within the DP.

A second case is that of dative possessors in various Germanic languages, e.g. in German:<sup>5</sup>

(5) dem Mann sein Buch ('the(dat.) man his book' = 'the man's book')  
which can clearly remain within DP.

A third comes from French, as in:

(6) un ami à moi ('a friend to me')

This à-phrase is clearly within DP (and in this case cannot move out of DP). It shows behavior strikingly parallel to that of ordinary sentential datives with respect to doubling and dislocation. Pronominal doubling of the non-dislocation sort is seen in both:

(7) mon ami à moi ('my friend to me')  
and in the sentential:

(8) Elle m'a parlé à moi. ('she me(dat.) has spoken to me')  
Right-dislocation is seen DP-internally in:<sup>6</sup>

(9) ses amis, à Jean ('his friends, to J')  
and in the sentential:

(10) Elle lui a parlé, à Jean. ('she him(dat.) has spoken, to J')

In addition, there is parallelism with respect to floating quantifiers of a certain sort:

faculty's counterpart of a motion detector. Arguments, at least, are visible only if they move, or only as they move.

<sup>3</sup>The question arises as to whether or not this conjecture could be taken to extend even to cases in which it seems that the argument is a NP, not a DP, as in English compounds and in various types of incorporation cross-linguistically. For relevant discussion, cf. Kayne (2024a). If Sportiche (2002) was right to take NP rather than DP to be the argument in the general case, then the text conjecture would apply to NP. As stated, the conjecture leaves open the question of landing-site; Thomas Leu (p.c.) notes the importance here, for object arguments, of past participle agreement as discussed in Kayne (1985: 1989).

<sup>4</sup>I will be setting aside the question of how much complexity there might be DP-internally. If the DP hypothesis were to turn out not to be correct, 'DP-internally' could be replaced by 'NP-internally'; for relevant discussion, see Bruening (2020) and Chomsky et al. (2019, 248).

<sup>5</sup>Cf. Sick (2006); also Fiva (1984; 1987) on Norwegian (without any visible dative marking).

<sup>6</sup>On this kind of right-dislocation, see Kayne (1975, sect. 2.20) and Vinet (1977).

(11) leur ami à tous ('their friend to all' = 'the friend of all of them')

(12) Elle leur a parlé à tous. ('she them(dat.) has spoken to all')

These three cases are all obviously compatible with (4).<sup>7</sup> As far as (3) is concerned, Szabolcsi takes the Hungarian DP-internal possessive dative to originate in a nominative position and to then move up into a Spec,DP position where it receives dative Case. If that proposal of hers is on the right track, and if it generalizes in one way or another to German, Norwegian, and French, then the above three cases are compatible with (3), too.

### 3. Datives that originate within DP and then move out.

One case comes again from Hungarian. Szabolcsi takes ordinary possessive sentences in Hungarian to involve a single DP argument of an existential verb. The possessor originates within that DP in a position that in some cases can directly show nominative (zero morphology). When the containing DP is indefinite, though, as it is in ordinary possessive sentences, the possessor obligatorily raises from the nominative position to a dative-assigning/licensing Spec,DP position and then obligatorily raises further, out of the DP and up into a sentential position, yielding what looks like a sentential dative.

In looking like a sentential dative, yet originating within DP, this Hungarian possessor shares a key property (despite the difference in Case) with familiar examples like subject-to-subject raising:

(13) We seem to have made a mistake.

We in this example looks like (and is) a matrix subject with nominative Case, yet has originated within the infinitive phrase, in a position in which Case is not otherwise licensed. Hungarian possessive sentences as analyzed by Szabolcsi share with such English raising sentences the basic property of having an argument occupying two distinct positions, at different points in the derivation.

Szabolcsi's proposal about Hungarian was extended in Kayne (1993) to English (and similar languages), which differ from Hungarian in having a verb *have*, whose possessor subject is nominative (apart from ECM contexts) and whose possessee object is accusative. If this extension to English and similar languages is on the right track, then in sentences like:

(14) He has two sisters.

the subject *he* has originated within the DP containing *two sisters*, in a way that recalls the somewhat marginal:

(15) (?)There exist two sisters of his.

in which *his* is clearly within the relevant single DP argument of *exist*.

We can note in passing that, in addition to (15), the Hungarian sentential possessive has a partial counterpart, though one that as in English lacks any visible dative, in Jacaltec (Mayan), where it appears to be fully productive, and the normal way of expressing simple possession:<sup>8</sup>

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<sup>7</sup>As far as I know, the French examples are compatible with a wide range of nouns. In that way and many others, these DP-internal datives are quite different from the camouflage cases of Collins, Moody and Postal (2008), which in some respects recall the French *Nous, on...* ('we, one...') sentences discussed in Kayne (1972, 95; 2009).

<sup>8</sup>Example from Craig (1977, 21).

(16) Ay no' hin txitam. ('exist classifier my pig' = 'I have a pig')

An obvious fact about (15) is that the argument phrase is obligatory:

(17) \*There exist(s).

very likely reflecting:<sup>9</sup>

(18) Every predicate must have (at least) one argument.

Worth noting here is that Szabolcsi's analysis, extended to (14), will allow (18) to in addition cover the following (setting aside VP-deletion possibilities):

(19) \*He has.

without any need for a selectional statement specifically involving *have*.

#### 4. Some other datives.

French allows:<sup>10</sup>

(20) Je lui croyais beaucoup d'amis. ('I him/her(dat.) thought many of friends')  
with an interpretation corresponding to that of:

(21) I thought (that) he/she had a lot of friends.

That is, (20), which at first glance seems to have a sentential dative, in fact has a 'have'-like interpretation, with the dative corresponding to the subject of 'have'.<sup>11</sup>

Setting aside the 'have' vs. 'be' question, Kayne (1981a) took (20) to contain a small clause, making it parallel, apart from the dative vs. accusative difference, to:

(22) Je le croyais intelligent. ('I him thought intelligent')

which is a familiar type of small clause sentence.

Just as (22) might contain a silent BE (capitals will indicate non-pronunciation), so might (20) seem at first glance to be a good candidate for containing a silent (possessive) HAVE. Yet silent BE is more likely to be correct, as a part of (22), than possessive HAVE is to be correct as a part of (20), for the following reason. Various languages, such as Russian, can leave finite *be* unpronounced under certain conditions (in Russian, in the present tense). Yet, no language that I know of leaves finite possessive *have* unpronounced. If English did, it would have, alongside the past tense sentence:

(23) We had a car back then.

the present tense sentence:

(24) \*We a car now.

If no language has an exact counterpart of (24), with nominative subject and accusative object, together with a possessive interpretation, then postulating a silent HAVE for (20) loses some of its plausibility.

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<sup>9</sup>On weather verbs, note Levin and Krejci (2019).

<sup>10</sup>For detailed discussion, cf. Ruwet (1981).

<sup>11</sup>It remains to be understood why:

i) \*Je lui croyais faim ('I him/her(dat.) thought hunger')

is not possible alongside:

ii) Il a faim. ('he has hunger')

especially since Romanian seems to have a direct counterpart of the embedded part of (i):

iii) Îmi este foame. ('me(dat.) is hunger')

as discussed in Săvescu Ciucivara (2006).

An alternative approach to (20) would take it to contain instead a silent BE, with the key idea being that the dative argument in (20) originates within the small clause and already has, within the small clause, its dative Case (whereas the accusative in (22) gets its accusative Case only in the matrix). In other words, (20) could be thought of as:

(25) je croyais [ lui(dat.) BE beaucoup d'amis ]  
in which the small clause has the form of an ordinary Hungarian possessive sentence (setting aside the question of the (non-)pronunciation of 'be'). If so, then in (20)/(25), dative *lui* may well have originated within the DP containing *beaucoup d'amis*, just as in Szabolcsi's analysis of Hungarian.

Guglielmo Cinque notes (p.c.) that this point about (20)/(25) arguably carries over to sentences like French:<sup>12</sup>

(26) Je ne lui aurais pas donné 50 ans. ('I neg. him/her(dat.) would-have not given 50 years')

which has an interpretation akin to that of:

(27) I wouldn't have said/guessed that he/she was 50 years old.  
Although the verb *donner* itself in (26) seems to contribute an interpretation that we might call idiomatic (i.e. not entirely predictable), it is clear that, allowing for that, the interpretation of (26) is calculable from:

(28) ...donné [ lui(dat.) BE 50 ans ]  
in which the small clause containing dative *lui* and *50 ans* is related, abstracting away again from the 'have'/'be' question, to the French way of expressing age:

(29) Il/Elle a 50 ans. ('he/she has 50 years')  
just as the small clause in (20)/(25) is related to:

(30) Il/Elle a beaucoup d'amis. ('he/she has many of friends')  
More exactly, (26)/(28) contains a small clause of the Hungarian possessive type, with a dative possessor.

English does not allow the literal counterpart of (26):

(31) \*I wouldn't have given him/her 50 years.  
in a way that is probably related to:

(32) \*He has/is 50 years.  
which is not possible in English as an expression of age. Nor does English have a literal counterpart of (20)/(25):

(33) \*I thought/believed him a lot of friends.  
But English has something fairly close to (20)/(25) and (26)/(28), namely:  
(34) John's doctors have given him only 3 months to live.  
with a sense like that of:  
(35) John's doctors have said that he has only 3 months to live.

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<sup>12</sup>Thomas Leu (p.c.) notes the following very interesting Swiss German facts, among others. To express *I'm 20*, Swiss German allows:

- i) Ich bi 20-i. ('I am 20-i')
- as well as:
- ii) Ich bi 20 jährig. ('I am 20 year-ig')
- Yet these two act differently with *give*:
- iii) Ich gäbt ərä nid 50-i. ('I would-give her not 50-i')
  - iv) \*Ich gäbt ərä nid 50-jährig.

or perhaps:

(36) John's doctors have given him to understand that he has only 3 months to live.  
The relation between *him* and *3 months to live* in (34) suggests:

(37) ...[ him BE only 3 months to live ]  
in which *him* is dative.

If (26)/(28) and (34)/(37) contain a possessive small clause with a dative possessor, then the same plausibly holds of:

(38) Ses parents voudraient lui donner une petite soeur. ('his/her parents would-like him/her(dat.) to-give a little sister')

(39) ...[ lui(dat.) BE une petite soeur ]  
in which again, following Szabolcsi, the dative possessor originates within the DP containing *une petite soeur*.

And then similarly for *give*-sentences in general, if we take them all to be thought of in a way parallel to (38)/(39). In that case, a sentence like:

(40) Mary gave him a copy of her paper.  
would be at some point in the derivation as in:  
(41) ...gave [ him(dat.) BE a copy of her paper ]

in which dative *him* originates, à la Szabolcsi, within the phrase *a copy of her paper*.

It follows, then, that in (41), at an early stage in the derivation, there must be a phrase containing both *him* and *a copy of her paper*, without containing BE. That phrase will therefore have two possessors, a conclusion made plausible despite initial appearances by the acceptability of:

(42) That paper/painting of hers of his is now worth a fortune.  
which to my ear is fine,<sup>13</sup> with *her* as 'author' and *his* as 'owner'.

## 5. The definiteness effect

Taking (38) to contain a possessive-type small clause allows (even though there is no *have/HAVE* in (38)) relating the core definiteness effect seen with respect to (38), seen in the following:<sup>14</sup>

(43) \*Ses parents voudraient lui donner la petite soeur. ('his/her parents would-like him/her(dat.) to-give the little sister')

(44) \*His parents would like to give him the little sister.  
to the comparable effect seen in possessive sentences with overt *have*:

(45) Jean a une/\*la petite soeur.

(46) John has a/\*the little sister.

This definiteness effect can be lifted, unsurprisingly now in both cases in the same way, by the addition of a relative clause:

(47) John now has the little sister that he's always wanted.

(48) John's parents would like to give him the little sister that he's always wanted.

## 6. Possessor raising.

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<sup>13</sup>More so, for reasons to be elucidated, than:

- i) ?his painting of hers
- ii) \*his her painting

<sup>14</sup>For a syntactic approach to this kind of definiteness effect, see Kayne (2019a).

A well-known case bearing on the potential correctness of the core proposal in (4), repeated here:

(49) All dative arguments originate DP-internally.

is that of possessor raising:

(50) Une pierre lui est tombée sur la tête. ('a stone him/her(dat.) is fallen on the head' = 'a stone fell on his/her head')

If the understood linkage between *lui* and *la tête* here is effected by external merge, then (49) is satisfied. Well-known are the challenges that arise. One has to do with non-restrictive adjectives:

(51) \*Une pierre lui est tombée sur la très belle tête. ('...very beautiful...')

A second challenge comes from facts about plurals:

(52) Elle leur a baisé les mains/\*têtes. ('she them(dat.) has kissed the hands/heads') that are also found in English:

(53) She kissed them on the hands/\*heads.

which contrasts with:

(54) She kissed them on their hands/heads.

A proposal that I made recently that arguably reconciles (51)-(53) with classical possessor raising for inalienables is as in the following, for the case of (53):<sup>15</sup>

(55) she kissed them on THEIR TOKENS OF the hands/\*heads

in which *the hands/\*heads* tracks:

(56) The hands/\*heads are an important part of the human body.

From the perspective of (55), *lui* in (50) would, as expected from (49), originate within the phrase 'TOKEN OF la tête'.

## 7. French causatives.

Other datives that I would like to address include those of French causatives of the sort seen in:<sup>16</sup>

(57) Jean a fait manger la tarte à Paul. ('J has made/had to-eat the pie to P' = 'J made/had P eat the pie')

in which dative-marked *Paul* corresponds to the subject of the infinitive *manger*. We can note initially that in a number of ways, the relation between *Paul* and infinitival subject position in (57) is appreciably closer to the ECM-type than to the control type.

First, a true control construction would not care about the transitivity of the embedded infinitive:

(58) \*Jean a fait manger à Paul. ('J has made eat to P')

In the absence of a direct object of the infinitive, the embedded subject in the causative generally cannot be preceded by *à* (but see below for refinements). Ordinary cases of control act quite differently:

(59) Jean a dit à Paul de manger (une tarte). ('J has said to P to eat (a pie)')

In this control example the presence or not of an embedded object is irrelevant.

Second, French control constructions never allow clitic climbing, whereas these causative constructions do:

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<sup>15</sup>Cf. Kayne (2020/2021).

<sup>16</sup>On the question how close Spanish causatives are (or are not) to French causatives, see Ordóñez (2024).

(60) Jean les a fait manger à Paul. ('J them has made eat to P')

(61) \*Jean les veut manger. ('J them wants to-eat')

(62) \*Jean les a dit à Paul de manger. ('J them has said to P to eat')

Third, control constructions always allow a clitic to remain on the infinitive, whereas in causatives, this is marginal at best (apart from reflexive cases<sup>17</sup>), and often impossible:

(63) \*Jean a fait les manger à Paul.

(64) Jean veut les manger.

(65) Jean a dit à Paul de les manger.

Fourth, control constructions normally have the controller preceding the infinitive, whereas in causatives the order is the reverse. In causatives, the order is as in (57) and (60), and not as in the following:

(66) \*Jean a fait à Paul manger une tarte.

(67) \*Jean les a fait à Paul manger.

This contrasts sharply with control examples:

(68) Jean a avoué à Paul avoir mangé une tarte. ('J has confessed to P to-have eaten a pie')

(69) Jean a dit à Paul de manger une tarte. ('J has said to P to eat a pie')

Finally, were (57) and (60) to be analyzed as control examples, they would violate an otherwise exceptionless generalization about French infinitival complementizers:<sup>18</sup>

(70) Infinitives with true object control must have an overt prepositional complementizer.

(69) is a typical case of object control and contains the complementizer *de*. (68) has no overt complementizer, but in fact can only be interpreted as subject control. The fact that there is no complementizer in (57) and (60) indicates that those causatives do not involve object control.

In conclusion, then, the DP following *à* in (57) and (60) is not a matrix controller.<sup>19</sup>

A different kind of consideration that favors a non-control analysis of causative sentences like (57) and (60) comes from the fact that the dative in such causatives can cover a wide range of thematic relations, in a way reminiscent of ECM constructions much more than of control. A relevant set of examples, including some with an inanimate causer and some with an inanimate dative, is:

(71) Son dernier bouquin a fait gagner beaucoup d'argent à Jean-Jacques ('his last book has made earn a-lot of money to J-J')

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<sup>17</sup>Which sometimes show optionality between climbing and non-climbing, in the case of *en* - v. Kayne (1975, sect. 6.5).

<sup>18</sup>A possible, if uncertain, exception is French *envoyer* ('to-send'); cf. Sheehan (2024) on Portuguese causative *mandar* ('to-send').

<sup>19</sup>There is no overt complementizer in:

(i) Il me semble avoir compris. ('it(explet.) me seems to-have understood' = 'I seem to have understood')

(ii) Il me faut partir. ('it(explet.) me is-necessary to-leave' = 'I have to leave')

Although the controller in these two examples seems to be a dative object, these controllers are almost certainly to be analyzed as dative subjects of the sort seen prominently in Icelandic - see Fernández-Soriano (1999) and references cited there.



(72) Tu vas faire perdre son poste à ton copain. ('you are-going to-make lose his job to your friend')

(73) Elle fera entendre raison à Jean. ('she will-make listen-to reason to J')

(74) Cela fera changer d'avis à Jean. ('that will-make change of opinion to J' = 'that will make J change his mind')

(75) Ce qui est arrivé a fait perdre de l'importance au fait que Jean aime Marie. ('that which has happened has made lose (of the) importance to-the fact that J loves M')

(76) On ne peut pas faire jouer un rôle important à tout. ('one neg can not make play a role important to everything' = 'one cannot have everything play an important role')

(77) Elle fera effleurer le filet à la balle. ('she will-make touch the net to the ball' = 'she will make the ball touch the net')

(78) Le coup de vent a fait traverser l'étang au petit voilier. ('the blast of wind has made cross the pond to-the little sailboat' = 'the blast of wind has made the little sailboat cross the pond')

(79) Cela fait préférer à Jean la syntaxe à la phonologie. ('that makes prefer to J the syntax to the phonology' = 'that makes J prefer syntax to phonology')

The conclusion that French causatives are not instances of control, but are instead ECM-like, will play a role in section 9.

## 8. Other cases of DP-internal origin

I note in passing that the core proposal in (49), repeated again here:

(80) All datives originate DP-internally.

bears a relation to the proposal in Kayne (2008) concerning expletives of the *there* sort, which I took to also originate DP-internally. This relation is indirectly reinforced by the fact that in some languages, such as (colloquial) Italian and many Italian dialects, one finds that their *there*-type expletive (in Italian, *ci*; in many northern dialects, *ghe*) can actually appear overtly in 'have'-sentences:

(81) Gianni c'ha un libro. ('G there has a book')

Of more direct interest to this paper is the fact that various Italian dialects, e.g. Paduan, have this same expletive in 'give'-sentences:

(82) Ghe dago un libro. ('there I-give a book' = 'I'm giving him/her/them a book')

The proposal developed in Kayne (2008) analyzes sentences like (82) as containing a silent dative third-person pronoun that is the true argument;<sup>20</sup> the expletive *ghe* of (82) is inherited from the possessive small clause that is part of *give*-sentences, as in (40)/(41). This yields, for (82), at an intermediate stage of the derivation:<sup>21</sup>

(83) dago [ ghe HIM(dat.) BE un libro]

## 9. Back to the DP-internal question and French causatives.

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<sup>20</sup>This third-person dative pronoun is seen overtly, together with the expletive, in some Sardinian, to judge by an example given by Jones (1993, 220):

(i) Narrabilis! ('tell *bi* to-them')

where *bi* is the Sardinian clitic parallel to *ghe*, and *lis* is the overt (plural) dative clitic (with the accusative unpronounced, as in some French); cf. Martín (2012) on Catalan.

<sup>21</sup>In a way that's fairly close to Sabel (2000).

The plausibility of a DP-internal source for datives is immediate in possessor raising cases, and is strikingly supported by examples of the following sort:

(84) John looked Bill \*(in the eye).

Taking *Bill* here to be dative (even in the absence of morphological confirmation), we can see that the very existence of this dative argument depends on the presence of a DP (here, *the eye*) that can give it a DP-internal source.

As noted earlier, the same holds for simple possessive sentences:

(85) John has \*(a sister).

The possessor *John* needs a DP in which to originate, again following Szabolcsi on Hungarian and my 1993 transposition of her analysis to English. (There is no need, from this perspective, to stipulate *have* as transitive.)

On the other hand, things are less straightforward in the case of French causatives. As discussed above, there is good reason to take French causatives with a dativized embedded infinitival subject to be ECM-like, e.g. in:

(86) Son dernier bouquin a fait gagner beaucoup d'argent à Jean-Jacques. ('his last book has made earn a-lot of money to J-J')

Saying that *Jean-Jacques* in this example is an infinitival ECM-type subject leaves open, however, the question of the external merge position of this infinitival subject.

If *Jean-Jacques* here is externally merged in Spec,VP or Spec,vP or Spec,VoiceP within the infinitival embedding, then the dative-marked infinitival subject in French causatives does not originate DP-internally. There is, though, evidence that may point in the opposite direction. To see how this might be, we need to go back to the standard generalization about French causatives:<sup>22</sup>

(87) (Syntax 101) The infinitival subject in French causatives is dative iff the infinitive has a direct object.

Now the *if*-part of (87) is highly accurate, and exceptionless for lexical DP subjects of the infinitive, as illustrated in:

(88) \*Son dernier bouquin a fait Jean-Jacques gagner beaucoup d'argent.

(89) \*Son dernier bouquin a fait gagner Jean-Jacques beaucoup d'argent.

(90) \*Son dernier bouquin a fait gagner beaucoup d'argent Jean-Jacques.

When there is a direct object (here, *beaucoup d'argent*) *Jean-Jacques* cannot remain without *à*.<sup>23</sup>

The *only if*-part of (87) is, however, what counts for this paper. Let me give it as:

(91) (Syntax 101) The infinitival subject in French causatives is dative only if the infinitive has a direct object.

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<sup>22</sup>Note that if the infinitive itself has a dative object, the causative can end up with two datives (cf. Kayne (1975, chap. 3, note 82)):

i) ?Il a fait porter à son domestique ces livres à sa femme. ('he has made carry to his servant those books to his wife' = 'he has made his servant carry...')

ii) Il lui a fait porter ces livres à sa femme. ('he him(dat.)...to his wife')

<sup>23</sup>An account in terms of Case was given by Rouveret and Vergnaud (1980). If *Jean-Jacques* is replaced by a pronominal clitic, however, accusative is sometimes possible (in a way that to some extent recalls Pollock (1985) on French ECM with *croire* ('believe')) - cf. Grevisse and Goosse (2008, sect. 903).

The generalization stated in (91) is not quite as accurate as it is sometimes thought to be. For example, Grevisse and Goosse (2008, sect. 903) have (from Robbe-Grillet):

(92) ...lui faire renoncer à son projet. ('him(dat.) make give-up to his project')

The verb *renoncer* has only a PP object *à son projet*, yet the infinitival subject *lui* is dative. In Kayne (1975, chap. 3, note 9), it was mentioned that for some speakers there are even cases where the first of the following, with the dative, is preferred to the second, with the accusative:

(93) Elle lui fera téléphoner à ses parents. ('she him/her(dat.) will-make telephone to his/her parents')

(94) Elle le fera téléphoner à ses parents. ('she him(acc.)...')

In addition, Morin (1980, 205) points out that examples such as (92) and (93) are in fact for many speakers very common when the dative is an object clitic, but a little less so when the dative subject is lexical. For the latter type, he gives as examples:

(95) On n'a pas réussi à faire parler de son voyage à Marie. ('we neg have not succeeded in making speak of her trip to M')

(96) C'est pas comme ça que tu arriveras à faire croire en Dieu à tes enfants. ('it is not like that that you will-manage to make believe in God to your children')

(97) Ils ont essayé en vain de faire tirer sur la foule à leurs soldats. ('they have tried in vain to make shoot at the crowd to their soldiers')

Of further importance is the immediately following observation of Morin's, to the effect that certain speakers accept a dative subject even when the infinitive has no complement at all, as in his examples:

(98) On leur fera patienter. ('we them(dat.) will-make wait')

(99) Je leur ai fait recommencer. ('I them(dat.) have made re-begin')

(100) Ça lui a fait réfléchir. ('that him(dat.) has made reflect')

However, the speakers in question accept the dative only when it is a clitic, not when it is lexical:<sup>24</sup>

(101) \*On fera patienter à nos fournisseurs. ('we will-make wait to our providers')

(102) \*On fera recommencer à Pierre. ('we will-make re-begin to P')

(103) \*Ça fera réfléchir à cette tête brûlée. ('that will-make reflect to that hothead')

The contrast between (101)-(103) and (95)-(97) is striking. For the speakers in question, in the absence of an embedded direct object, a lexical dative subject is possible when an overt PP is present, as in (95)-(97), but not when the verb has no complement at all, as in (101)-(103).

There is a clear linkage to be seen now between this contrast and (91) itself, repeated here, in its essentials:

(104) The infinitival subject in French causatives is dative only if the infinitive has a direct object.

For lexical infinitival subjects, (104) is in fact accurate for one subset of French speakers. For another subset, (104) must be relaxed to allow for the sole presence of a PP object, as in (95)-(97), but cannot be relaxed any further than that, as shown by (101)-(103).

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<sup>24</sup>This asymmetry between dative clitics and lexical datives may be related to the often obligatory character of dative clitic doubling in Spanish.

The next question is, why should there be a subset of speakers who can relax (104) just to that extent? And if for those speakers a direct object of the infinitive is not necessary in order to have a dative subject, why do they still require a PP object?

#### 10. Dative Case

At this point it becomes useful to isolate two separate questions concerning French causatives (and datives more generally). One can be phrased as a slightly modified version of (80), as follows:

(105) Do all dative arguments originate DP-internally?

The other is:

(106) Where does dative Case originate?

That these two questions are indeed to be taken separately (as is standard for nominative and for ECM-type accusative arguments) is shown by consideration of Szabolcsi's analysis of Hungarian possessive sentences, which has dative Case assigned (to the raised possessor) in Spec,DP, i.e. above D itself; yet at the same time that raised possessor originates in a Spec position below D.<sup>25</sup>

In French causatives, the dative Case itself that is assigned to the embedded infinitival subject may well be assigned at the matrix level, as in Rouveret and Vergnaud (1980) and, with an ECM twist, in Kayne (2004), even if the argument in question originates DP-internally.

Of interest now is a generalization that comes to the fore if one combines the unaccusative hypothesis with the approach to unergatives found in Hale and Keyser (1993; 2002). If Hale and Keyser are on the right track, then unergatives such as *sleep* are hidden transitives, in the sense that they in fact are built from a noun *sleep* combined with a light verb that is silent in English but pronounced in Basque.

Unaccusatives like *arrive* are to be analyzed, in the tradition of Perlmutter (1978; 1989) and Burzio (1986), as containing a subject that has originated in object position.

Combining these two hypotheses we reach the following conclusion:

(107) All verbs have a direct object.

Possibly, this is to be understood as saying that all verbs have an object accompanied by no adposition at any stage of the derivation.<sup>26</sup> If so, then a dative-Case-marked phrase will always be accompanied by a direct object.<sup>27</sup>

On the assumption that the direct object that necessarily accompanies every dative cannot be itself, i.e. on the assumption that an underlying direct object can never itself be dativized, we have an account of a generalization given by Authier and Reed (1991,

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<sup>25</sup>Relevant, too, is Leu (2015, chapter 7) on German Case morphemes.

<sup>26</sup>Relevant here is the suggestion made in Kayne (2004) to the effect that light Ps are externally merged, not with the DP we think of as their object, but rather with VP.

There may also be a link here to the suggestion made in Kayne (1998) that all functional projections must have a filled Spec at some point in the derivation.

<sup>27</sup>How DOM sentences should be integrated here remains to be determined - for relevant discussion, cf. Torrego (1998) and Odria (2014), among many others.

199-200), to the effect that the ‘subject’ (= underlying direct object) of an unaccusative cannot be dativized:<sup>28</sup>

(108) \*Ça lui a fait noircir. (‘that it(dat.) has made blacken’)

(109) \*Ça lui a fait arriver. (‘...arrive’)

As far as I know this is so even in the presence of a PP:

(110) \*On lui a fait rentrer dans sa chambre. (‘they him/her(dat.) have made go-back into his/her room’)

The dative *lui* in (108)-(110) is excluded since it corresponds to an underlying direct object, and the same is true of:

(111) \*Ça lui a fait devenir un professeur célèbre. (‘that him/her has made become a professor famous’)

on the assumption that *devenir* is unaccusative (as clearly indicated by its taking auxiliary ‘be’).

Returning now to (92)-(100), in which there is no visible direct object, there must, given (107), be in such sentences a silent direct object of one sort or another. For example, in (93), repeated here:

(112) Elle lui fera téléphoner à ses parents. (‘she him/her will-make telephone to his/her parents’)

we could have, à la Hale and Keyser, something akin to:

(113) Elle lui fera donner un coup de téléphone à ses parents. (‘she him/her will-make give a telephone call to his/her parents’)

On the other hand, as seen in (101)-(103) and in cases like:

(114) Elle lui fera manger \*(une tarte). (‘she him/her(dat.) will-make eat a pie’)  
a silent object is not always sufficient to reach acceptability, in a way that recalls the challenging question of when, in an ergative Case language, the subject of an unergative verb can bear ergative Case.<sup>29</sup>

## 11. Sources

Putting dative Case in the background now, let us get back, for French causatives, to the question whether or not arguments marked with dative are externally merged in some DP-internal position.

As an initial example, let us take Morin’s (95), repeated here:

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<sup>28</sup>They note the exceptional case of *intervenir*, which, to judge by its taking auxiliary ‘be’, is unaccusative; yet one has:

i) Cela lui a fait intervenir dans la discussion. (‘that him/her has made intervene in the discussion’)

relevant to which is the proposal in Kayne (to appear), following which (i) would be much as in:

ii) That made him make himself intervene in the discussion.

<sup>29</sup>For relevant discussion, cf. Woolford (2015) and Berro (2019).

The potential linkage between dative and ergative leads one to wonder, as suggested by Thomas Leu (p.c.), if aspect (imperfective vs. perfective) might play a role in licensing dative Case, too, thinking of various split ergative languages and of the aspectual difference between *eat* and *eat a pie*.

(115) On n'a pas réussi à faire parler de son voyage à Marie. ('we neg have not succeeded in making speak of her trip to M')

Can the dativized subject *Marie* have originated within the DP *son voyage*, itself the object of *de*? A possible proposal would be to take *Marie* here to originate as a double of *son*:

(116) [ [Marie] son voyage ]

recalling German *dem Mann sein Buch*, as in (5) above, and, less directly:

(117) son voyage, à Marie

(118) son voyage à elle

There is admittedly a bit of tension here, given that in (115), *Marie* is also understood as the subject of the infinitive *parler* ('to-speak'), which now appears to have no phrase externally merged as its subject. We can resolve this tension by adopting the approach to pronouns and their antecedents given in Kayne (2002), whereby doubles can move into theta-positions, in a way that recalls Hornstein (1999), but differs from him insofar as movement of a double into a theta position does not force a phrase to have more than one theta role. In (115), *Marie* will get the subject theta role of *parler*, but the possessor theta role that goes with *voyage* will be assigned, not to *Marie*, but rather to the more complex [ *Marie son* ] (or, better, [ *Marie s-* ]).

That the dative (lexical) subject in French causatives should be in a possessive relation with an object of the infinitive makes immediate sense for a number of our earlier examples, starting with:

(119) Tu vas faire perdre son poste à ton copain. ('you are-going to-make lose his job to your friend')

in which, as in (115), there is an overt possessive *son* within the infinitival object. But even when there is no overt possessive, as in:

(120) Cela fera changer d'avis à Jean. ('that will-make change of opinion to J' = 'that will make J change his mind')

there is plausibly a silent one, given the closeness between the following two:

(121) John frequently changes opinions.

(122) John frequently changes his mind.

In other words, *avis* in (120) can be taken to have a silent counterpart of the *son* of (119), with *Jean* in (120) then starting out as the double of that silent SON.

And similarly for:

(123) Ce qui est arrivé a fait perdre de l'importance au fait que Jean aime Marie. ('that which has happened has made lose (of the) importance to-the fact that J loves M')

thinking of the closeness between the two versions in:

(124) The fact that John loves Mary has over time lost (its) importance.

The same arguably holds for:

(125) On ne peut pas faire jouer un rôle important à tout. ('one neg can not make play a role important to everything' = 'one cannot have everything play an important role')

thinking of:

(126) Everything has (its) importance.

as well as for:

(127) Elle fera effleurer le filet à la balle. ('she will-make touch the net to the ball' = 'she will make the ball touch the net')

thinking of:

(128) The ball touched the/?its net.

and for:

(129) Le coup de vent a fait traverser l'étang au petit voilier. ('the blast of wind has made cross the pond to-the little sailboat' = 'the blast of wind has made the little sailboat cross the pond')

given:

(130) The little sailboat crossed the/its pond.

and even for:

(131) Cela fait préférer à Jean la syntaxe à la phonologie. ('that makes prefer to J the syntax to the phonology' = 'that makes J prefer syntax to phonology')

against the background of:

(132) John prefers (his) syntax to phonology.

## 12. Clitics.

Consider this example:

(133) Ils ont fait manger les légumes à l'enfant. ('they have made to-eat the vegetables to the-child')

In the spirit of the preceding section, we can analyze this kind of example in terms of a silent possessor contained within *les légumes* of which 'the child' will be the double:

(134) ...à l'enfant les SES légumes...

where SES (perhaps better as just S-) is the silent possessor and *l'enfant* the double.

Now in (133) the infinitival object *les légumes* can be replaced by a pronominal object clitic *les* ('them'):

(135) Ils les ont fait manger à l'enfant.

The analysis illustrated in (134) will generalize to (135) if, much as in Postal (1966), (135) contains a silent counterpart of *légumes* (as well as a silent possessor):<sup>30</sup>

(136) ils les S(ES) LEGUMES ont fait manger à l'enfant.

## 13. Dative arguments that are locative.

In some languages, some locatives show dative Case, e.g. in German:

(137) im Bahnhof ('in-the(dative) station')

with *-m* the dative Case morpheme. To integrate this kind of dative with all the rest, let me adopt Terzi's (2010) analysis, which takes most locatives to be possessors of a silent noun PLACE. From that perspective, the dative Case seen in this German example is closely related to the dative Case seen in German possessors in (5) above, repeated again here:

(138) dem Mann sein Buch ('the(dative) man his book')

and to the dative Case on possessors in other languages.<sup>31</sup>

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<sup>30</sup>The exact position of LEGUMES might not be the one given. For recent relevant discussion, cf. Giurgea and Ivan (2023).

<sup>31</sup>The implications of the syntactic structure proposed by Terzi (2010) for Caha's (2013) Case sequence/hierarchy will need to be looked into, as will the question of what exactly regulates the non-appearance of dative Case with many locatives (as with many non-locative possessors).

#### 14. Temporals.

In some languages, some temporals show dative Case, e.g. in German:

(139) vor einem Tag ('before one(dat.) day' = 'a day ago')

The possessor idea of the previous section lends itself to reuse, thinking of:

(140) I think we can finish it in two hours' time.

In other words, there is plausibly in (139) a silent noun TIME of which *einem Tag* is the possessor.

#### 15. Modals.

Harves and Kayne (2012) argued that transitive verbal *need*, in those languages in which it is found, should be analyzed in the manner of Hale and Keyser (1993; 2002), with such instances of *need* being built on a structure containing nominal *need* and a silent counterpart HAVE of *have*.<sup>32</sup> (The contrast with (24) above suggests that silent finite HAVE can be licensed by the incorporation of *need*.)

Now English sentences like:

(141) They need that book.

and French sentences like:

(142) Ils ont besoin de ce livre. ('they have need of that book')

don't bear directly on the claims of this paper since they contain no dative-marked phrase. French, though, has another way of expressing something quite close to (142) in which a dative does appear:

(143) Il leur faut ce livre. ('it them(dat.) need/must that book')

The key question is where dative *leur* in (142) originates. One possibility consistent with the main claim of this paper is that it is externally merged internal to the DP *ce livre*, though that doesn't seem quite right, interpretively speaking. Nor would that idea automatically carry over to:

(144) Il leur faut partir. ('it them(dat.) need/must to-leave')

French infinitives are almost certainly nominal,<sup>33</sup> and they may be DPs, even though an overt D is generally not allowed:

(145) \*Il leur faut le partir. ('it them(dat.) need/must the to-leave')

But even if they are DPs, and even if *leur* started out within the infinitive,<sup>34</sup> the notion of possessive relation that played a role in all of the preceding discussion in this paper would need to be stretched considerably to cover the relation between *leur* and the infinitive in (144).

The alternative is to go back to Harves and Kayne (2012) and more specifically to Cattaneo's (2009, chapter 5) idea that other (Italian) modals should be treated as we had treated *need*. In other words, we could take *faut* (with infinitive *falloir*) to be denominal in the Hale and Keyser sense, i.e. to involve a nominal element *fal-* that

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<sup>32</sup>For an extension to English modal-like *need*, cf. Kayne (2024b).

<sup>33</sup>Cf. Raposo (1987) and Kayne (1999).

<sup>34</sup>In an ECM-like fashion. Note the impossibility of:

i) \*Il faut partir à ces étudiants. ('it need/must to-leave to those students')

whose contrast with its dative clitic counterpart recalls French causatives in some cases discussed earlier.



combines with a silent verb, either HAVE or, more likely, BE. *Leur* in (143) and (144) would then originate as a possessor of this *fal-*, much as *they* in (141) arguably originates as a possessor of nominal *need*.

#### 16. Psych-verbs.

French psych-verbs (unlike those of English) sometimes show dative:

(146) *Ça leur fait peur.* ('that them(dat.) makes fear' = 'that frightens them')

Here, too, it is plausible to take *leur* to originate as a possessor of *peur*, much as in the more transparent:

(147) *Ils ont peur.* ('they have fear')

#### 17. Conclusion.

To say that all dative arguments originate DP-internally is appreciably less implausible than it might initially sound.

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